Nearest neighbours

Data science · Level 3 · Lesson 3



In this lesson you will

- Tell labels from numbers.
- Classify by nearest neighbours.
- Choose k sensibly.

Key ideas

- Classification predicts a label.
- The nearest k vote.
- Rescale before measuring distance.

The mystery fruit

1. Warm-up (5 min): What fruit is it?
2. Measure (10 min): Weigh and score.
3. Classify (10 min): Mystery fruits.
4. Wrap-up (5 min): What did you find out?

Let’s discuss

1. When did k change the answer?
2. Is a fruit type a number or a label?
3. Why rescale the grams?

Exit ticket

- Neighbours: blue, red, blue, green, blue. With k = 5, which label wins?